

Dear Editors,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, "Evidence Without Conclusion: Localising Failure in Autonomous LLM Agent Systems", for publication in *Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems* as a Regular Paper.

The paper reports two studies — the second pre-registered, with the design frozen before any confirmatory data were seen — in Meridian, a deterministic multi-agent testbed in which societies of LLM-based agents choose their own measurements, maintain explicit probabilistic beliefs, and may communicate at will, while an environmental law changes covertly mid-run. Its central contribution is an evaluation decomposition that separates evidence acquisition from inference using a non-LLM change-point detector run on exactly the measurements the agents themselves chose to take: the agents' measurement policy outperforms a fixed reference schedule, yet one agent of 276 concludes the law changed. Because no condition schedules, routes or requires communication, the paper also measures a quantity that standard multi-agent architectures make structurally unobservable — whether agents communicate at all — and what a catalysed channel carries when they do.

In line with Springer Nature's preprint policy, I disclose that an earlier version of this manuscript, under a previous title and framing, is self-deposited on Zenodo (concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21906653, CC BY 4.0); the Study 1 preprint on which this paper builds is separately deposited (10.5281/zenodo.21872780). Neither has been published in, nor is under consideration by, any archival venue, and this manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere. The Zenodo records will be updated with the JAAMAS citation on acceptance. Full details are in the accompanying information sheet, together with the required statements on prior publication, evidence, and related work.

The model code is published in the CoMSES Computational Model Library, the complete raw run artifacts are deposited on Zenodo, and every number in the paper is reproducible from the deposited artifacts; data and code availability statements with DOIs are included in the manuscript's Statements and Declarations.

Thank you for your consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Nick Lamb Independent Researcher, Oxford, United Kingdom ORCID: 0009-0009-6266-8499 · nick@pharmatools.ai